

Rodrigo Alonso Jorquera Díaz

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SUMMARY

Computer Engineering student focused on Machine Learning and applied AI research, working toward a future as an AI Engineer / AI Researcher. Skilled in gradient-boosted ensembles (XGBoost, LightGBM, CatBoost), rigorous cross-validation design, and end-to-end model development; currently expanding into LLM tooling and open research problems. Favor real-world impact over purely leaderboard-driven competitions. Winner of the EY AI & Data Challenge 2026 (over 45,000 participants), Teaching Assistant for Advanced Programming, and active member of the student initiative Ingeniería para Chile.

EDUCATION

B.S. in Engineering, Major in Computer Science

Pontifical Catholic University of Chile

2023 – Present

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant

July 2025 – Present

Pontifical Catholic University of Chile

- Teaching Assistant (grader) for Advanced Programming (IIC2233), a mid-level course (Python, VS Code) with weekly assignments, in-class activities, and written exams.
- Ran and tested student-submitted code, verifying functional correctness and identifying design flaws.
- Graded in-class activities completed on Ubuntu/Lite XL, an environment designed to prevent AI-assisted coding and assess genuine understanding.
- Provided detailed technical feedback to promote good programming practices (readability, modularity, error handling and others).

Computing Committee Member

March 2025 – Present

Ingeniería para Chile – Pontifical Catholic University of Chile

- Developed a website for the Municipal Public Works Department (DOM) of El Bosque, focused on data visualization through an interactive map with per-department layers.
- Built the initiative's own website for Ingeniería para Chile.
- Contributing to a project for the Disaster Risk Management Department (DGRD) of Ñuñoa Municipality (ongoing).
- Tech stack: React, JavaScript, CSS, Python.

Outreach Sub-coordinator

March 2025 – Present

Ingeniería para Chile – Pontifical Catholic University of Chile

- Promoted to Sub-coordinator (July 2025), planning content calendars, defining publishing dates, and attending initiative-wide coordination meetings.
- Produced and edited video content and designed graphics for social media.
- Supported the development of the initiative's visual identity (logos, brand guidelines) in Figma.
- Helped promote events and represented the initiative at student fairs.

Administrative Intern

July 2025 – September 2025

Municipality of Puente Alto

- Interned at the Municipal Planning Department (SECPLA), conducting a citywide survey of participatory paving projects.
- Took on-site photographs of paved sections, then georeferenced and uploaded them using Google Earth, measuring distances to assess damage proportion relative to affected road length.
- Assessed pavement condition and material (asphalt vs. concrete), classifying sections as good or damaged and identifying candidates for reconstruction and repaving.
- Planned follow-up site visits to re-survey sections, verify current conditions, and discuss findings for future paving interventions.

EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES & ACHIEVEMENTS

- GCI World** | *Matsuo-Iwasawa Lab, University of Tokyo* 2026 (ongoing)
- Selected for the global AI/Data Science program run by the Matsuo-Iwasawa Lab (supported by JICA); covering supervised/unsupervised ML, time series, and feature engineering.
- Claude Impact Lab** | *Anthropic* May 2026
- Selected as one of 200 builders for the first Claude Impact Lab in Latin America (Chile chosen among 9 countries), held at Chile Fintech Forum 2026 (Espacio Riesco, Santiago).
 - Competed in the Consumer Data Protection track, designing an AI-powered chatbot to automatically classify citizen complaints and route them directly into municipal management systems.
- Global Winner** | *EY AI & Data Challenge 2026* 2026
- 1st place globally out of ~45,000 participants, with a water quality prediction model for South African rivers (final score: 0.8109 R^2).
 - Migrated the winning solution to Snowflake after the competition; awarded an invitation to Snowflake Summit 2026 (San Francisco, CA) to present the solution on a panel.

SKILLS AND KNOWLEDGE

Programming:

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| ■ Python (advanced): OOP, threading, GUI (PyQt) | ■ VHDL (intermediate) |
| ■ JavaScript / React (intermediate) | ■ PHP (intermediate) |
| ■ SQL (intermediate) | ■ HTML / CSS (intermediate) |
| ■ C (intermediate) | ■ R (basic) |

Machine Learning / Data Science:

- XGBoost, LightGBM, CatBoost, Optuna (Bayesian hyperparameter tuning), scikit-learn
- Spatial/temporal validation (GroupKFold, StratifiedGroupKFold), feature engineering
- Deep Learning (PyTorch)

AI Tools:

- Claude Code, Codex, GitHub Copilot
- Ollama, LM Studio (local LLM tooling)

Software:

- PowerPoint
- Figma
- Excel

Languages:

- Spanish: Native
- English: Intermediate